

- 2 (a) Gravitational force provides centripetal force. Same gravitational force acting on star and planet.
(i)

$$F_G = m_p r_p \omega^2 = m_s r_s \omega^2 \quad \text{C1}$$

$$2.0 \times 10^{27} (r_p) = 6.0 \times 10^{28} (r_s)$$

$$\frac{r_s}{r_p} = \frac{2.0 \times 10^{27}}{6.0 \times 10^{28}} = \frac{1}{30}$$

$$r_s = \frac{1}{30} \times 5.2 \times 10^9 = 1.68 \times 10^8 \text{ m} \quad \text{A1}$$

(a) $F_G = F_C$

(ii)
$$\frac{G m_s m_p}{d^2} = m_s r_s \omega^2$$

$$\frac{G m_s m_p}{d^2} = m_s r_s \left(\frac{2\pi}{T} \right)^2 \quad \text{C1}$$

$$\frac{6.67 \times 10^{-11} (2.0 \times 10^{27})}{(5.2 \times 10^9)^2} = (1.68 \times 10^8) \left(\frac{2\pi}{T} \right)^2$$

$$T = 1.16 \times 10^6 \text{ s} \quad \text{A1}$$

(a) Planet moves in front of star periodically. A1
(iii)

(b) Between starting height 6.40×10^6 m & ending height 7.225×10^6 m

(i) $g = (-) \frac{d\phi}{dr}$

$$\Delta\phi = \int g \, dr$$

= area under g-r graph

$$= 6.74 \times 10^6 \text{ to } 7.61 \times 10^6 \text{ J kg}^{-1}$$

C1
M1

$$\Delta U = m\Delta\phi = 2300 \Delta\phi$$

$$= 1.55 \times 10^{10} \text{ to } 1.75 \times 10^{10} \text{ J}$$

M1

OR

$$g = G \frac{M}{r^2} \text{ and } \phi = -G \frac{M}{r} \Rightarrow \phi = -gr$$

C1

$$\Delta U = m\Delta\phi = m(\phi_f - \phi_i) = 2300(g_i r_i - g_f r_f)$$

$$= 2300(-9.75 \times 6.4 \times 10^6 + 7.625 \times 7.225 \times 10^6)$$

$$\approx 1.60 \times 10^{10} \text{ J}$$

M1
M1

(b)
(ii) $\Delta U = U_f - U_i = -\frac{GM_E m_s}{r_f} - \left(-\frac{GM_E m_s}{r_i} \right)$

$$1.6 \times 10^{10} = 6.67 \times 10^{-11} M_E (2300) \left(\frac{1}{6.40 \times 10^6} - \frac{1}{7.225 \times 10^6} \right)$$

C1

$$M_E = 5.85 \times 10^{24} \text{ kg}$$

A1

(b) Advantages to low polar orbit:

(iii) • High(er) resolution imaging/clearer images

A1

• Image more of the planet as the Earth spins underneath the satellite

Geostationary:

• **Remain at the same position in the sky so satellite dishes can keep locked on to signal/no steerable dishes needed/send & receive signals all the times/continuous/uninterrupted/stable signals**

A1

• Higher orbit means greater coverage of the signals